MIDI Bridge

Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

A menu bar app (on Windows, a system tray app) keeping a permanent two-way link between your DAW and the dLive: it gives your DAW the “MIDI Bridge” MIDI ports and shuttles everything to the console over the network (MIDI over TCP). Set up before the 2026 rename, your ports keep their old name, “dLive Bridge”. Windows differs in a few places: see **On Windows**.

Menu bar disc

Click	Show / hide the control panel.
Right-click	Show MIDI Monitor, Reload MIDI Monitor, or Quit (Quit is also in the panel footer).
Disc colour	Grey outline = stopped · Red = no connection · Amber, breathing = connecting · Green = connected · Cyan flash = MIDI flowing · Amber ! = error (click the status tile to open the log).

First-run setup

Console IP (MixRack) / Port	The MixRack’s address, not the Surface’s. Port defaults to 51325 (dLive MIDI over TCP).
Base MIDI Channel	Must match Utility → Control → MIDI on the console.
Your DAW	Restart your DAW after the bridge’s first start so “MIDI Bridge” (or, on an older setup, “dLive Bridge”) appears in its MIDI output list.

Options

Auto-reconnect	On: after a drop the bridge retries hard for 30 s, then every 30 s. Off: it stays red until you click Restart Bridge.
Verbose logging	Writes every MIDI message with raw bytes to the log. Debugging only — the log grows quickly.
Start at login	Launches the bridge with the Mac (default on).
Option key (held)	Reveals “Edit config file…” for advanced settings.

MIDI monitor

Panel peek	The last 5 MIDI events, live, under MIDI ACTIVITY.
Show MIDI Monitor…	The full stream: filter by direction, type or source, search, pause, click a row for raw bytes. Open it from the panel, or by right-clicking the menu bar disc.
Finding the window again	While the monitor is open the app appears in the Dock and in Cmd-Tab, and the window is listed in the Window menu. It follows you to whichever desktop Space you are on, and keeps its log when you reopen it.
Source labels	Every row is tagged with where it came from — your DAW, the console’s surface, the bridge’s own housekeeping, or a connected app by name (e.g. “Pilot Tone Trigger”). Use the source menu to watch one at a time.
Actions	Outgoing Control Changes on the base channel are shown as probable console Actions. Which Action a CC triggers is bound on the console, so the bridge flags the intent, not the name.
Simple / Advanced view	The monitor hides low-level protocol scaffolding by default; switch to **Advanced** to see everything on the wire — fader pings, heartbeat probes, NRPN address messages — for deep debugging.
The two dots	“bridge” = link to the bridge app; “console” = the bridge’s link to the desk — only the second means you reach the console.

Sharing the console

One link, many apps	Other software can reach the desk through the bridge instead of opening its own connection to the console. Talk Light Trigger, Pilot Tone Trigger and Console Control do this automatically when pointed at the bridge's port, and Bitfocus Companion can connect to the bridge too.
Why it helps	One link to the console instead of several, and each app's traffic is labelled by name in the monitor, so you can see exactly what sent what.
MIDI Bridge Return	Console activity is passed back to your DAW on this second port ("dLive Bridge Return" on an older setup). The bridge's own background housekeeping is not, so it no longer clutters what your DAW receives.

Running it

Start / Stop / Restart	Controls the bridge process. After changing a connection setting, click Restart Bridge to apply it.
Status tile	Mirrors the menu bar disc, plus host, last activity and msg/s.

Important — if the bridge sits at "Connecting…" while the desk is reachable, another controller may be holding the console's MIDI-over-TCP port. Quit the A&H MIDI Driver (or other control software) and click Restart Bridge.

Bitfocus Companion

Loopback only, port 8770, nothing to set up on this side — add MIDI Bridge in the dylanmaudio Companion module.

What it controls	Start, stop and restart the bridge, and Auto-reconnect — as Companion buttons, with the menu bar disc's state, MIDI activity, message rate and any error shown back on them. Every dLive function (faders, mutes, scenes…) still goes through the bridge's console connection, as under "Sharing the console".
Allow Companion control	On by default. Off refuses every Companion press; Companion can still show why.
Lock show-critical controls	Off by default. On refuses stopping and restarting the bridge from Companion — starting it and Auto-reconnect are never locked.
Auto-reconnect	A change from Companion is saved at once and applies the next time the bridge starts, exactly like the checkbox in the panel.

Log files

Where they live	All in **~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/MIDI Bridge/**, one folder per dylanmaudio app — right-click the menu bar icon and choose **Open Log Folder**. Or skip the folder: **Export log** in the panel footer saves a diagnostics zip to your Desktop (this session's log, the previous one, and your settings) and shows it in Finder.
Session log	One file per launch, named by the time you opened the app. What the bridge is doing — connections, reconnects, each app that connects to it, errors — plus your settings at launch and every change. This is the one "Open Log" shows you, and the one to send if something goes wrong. The newest 20 are kept.
dlive-midi.jsonl	Every MIDI message, one line each, for detailed diagnosis. **Off by default** — turn on **midi_log** in the config file (hold Option in the panel to reveal "Edit config file…"). It grows quickly.
Managing it	The MIDI Monitor's footer shows its size, with **Save a copy** and **Clear log file** beside it — no need to go looking for the file. A saved copy lands in the same folder, stamped with the date and time.
Rotation	The MIDI log renames itself to **.jsonl.1** at 100 MB and starts fresh, and any previous **.jsonl.1** is discarded at that point. Save a copy first if you need to keep a capture.

On Windows

Install	Run **MIDI Bridge Setup**: it installs for you alone, with no administrator prompt. Start menu → **dylanmaudio** holds MIDI Bridge, this guide and the uninstaller. An update installs over the old one; if MIDI Bridge is running, Setup offers to close it first (say No if a show is running).
MIDI ports (loopMIDI)	Windows can't make MIDI ports for an app, so the bridge uses ports you make in the free **loopMIDI** (tobias-erichsen.de): create two, named exactly **MIDI Bridge** and **MIDI Bridge Return**, then click Restart Bridge. Without them the bridge still links the console to Companion and the other apps, and the panel says **No DAW port**.
The tray icon	Windows puts a new tray icon under the **^** by the clock. Drag it onto the taskbar to keep it in view. Click and right-click work as the menu bar disc does above. The first launch opens the panel for you.
Start at login	The same option in the panel. It also shows in Task Manager → Startup apps; switching it off there is respected.
Edit config file	Hold **Alt** instead of Option.
Logs and settings	Logs: **%LOCALAPPDATA%\dylanmaudio\Logs\MIDI Bridge** (Open Log Folder in the tray menu). Settings: **%APPDATA%\dylanmaudio\dLive Bridge**. Export log saves its zip to your Desktop and opens Explorer.
Uninstall	Start menu → dylanmaudio → Uninstall MIDI Bridge, or Settings → Apps. It asks whether to remove your settings and logs too; keep them if you might reinstall.

What's new in v1.4.5

• New: MIDI Bridge for Windows 10 and 11 (64-bit), in the system tray. A DAW connects through two ports made in the free loopMIDI; the Quick Reference shows how.
• Fixed: if the console's base MIDI channel didn't match MIDI Bridge's and the console was otherwise idle, MIDI Bridge reconnected every few seconds without saying why. It now asks the console which channel it's on, tells you which base channel to set, and stops reconnecting.
• The app is now called MIDI Bridge, ready for Windows. Installing it replaces "MIDI Bridge - dLive" in place: your settings, MIDI port names, Launch at Login and Companion connection carry on unchanged. If Launch at Login is on, MIDI Bridge opens when the update finishes, so it starts at your next login under its new name.
• New: a Console drop-down in the Connection section. dLive is the only console for now; more are coming.
• New installs name the MIDI ports "MIDI Bridge" and "MIDI Bridge Return". If you already use MIDI Bridge, your ports keep their "dLive Bridge" names, so your QLab, Reaper and Companion setups work as before. Talk Light Trigger, Pilot Tone Trigger and Console Control find the bridge under either name.